



T E C H N O V A 2 0 2 6



CRACK THE CODE

The AI doesn't want to talk. Your job is to make it.

P R O M P T E N G I N E E R I N G

DESIGNED BY

NIMRA YOUSUF

SYED AYAAN NADEEM

HUZAIFA AHMED

// CRACK_THE_CODE · OFFICIAL RULE BOOK

CRACK THE CODE

PROMPT ENGINEERING · THE PROMPT GAUNTLET

*The AI doesn't want to talk. Your job is to make it.***Solo**

NO TEAMS

AUG 1ST

2026

2:00-4:00

PM

IoBM

KARACHI

// MODULE_OVERVIEW

01

THE MODULE

CONTROL THE AI OR BE CONTROLLED BY IT

Crack the Code is the **Prompt Gauntlet: Extreme Edition**: a solo prompt-engineering tournament where language is your only weapon. Across five elimination rounds, competitors face escalating challenges that test how precisely, efficiently, and adaptively they can bend an AI to produce exactly the output required.

There are no teammates to lean on and no second chances. Every prompt is yours alone, every round raises the stakes, and only the sharpest minds survive.

// FORMAT

02 FORMAT

FIVE ROUNDS · INDIVIDUAL · ELIMINATION

- > **Solo competition:** one competitor, no teams. Every decision is yours alone.
- > **Five rounds:** difficulty escalates as the field narrows.
- > **Elimination format:** competitors are cut across the rounds; there are no restarts and no second chances.
- > **Judged & scored live:** a judge panel works alongside live automated scoring.
- > **Only the sharpest advance:** the strongest competitors reach the final round.

// **note:** Each round's specific challenge is revealed live, in the room. Come ready to read the task fast and respond under pressure.

// HOW_TO_PREPARE

03 WHAT IT TAKES

SHARPEN THE FUNDAMENTALS

You can't pre-write your way through the Gauntlet; there's no script for what's coming. What you **can** do is arrive fluent in the fundamentals:

- > **Precision:** say exactly what you mean and nothing you don't.
- > **Economy:** get more from fewer, sharper words.
- > **Adaptability:** adjust a prompt quickly when the situation shifts.
- > **Speed:** think and type fast; the clock is part of the test.

// TOOLS_AND_ACCESS

04 TOOLS & WHAT'S ALLOWED

YOUR WEAPON IS LANGUAGE, WIELD IT CLEANLY

- > **AI tools are permitted.** Use your chosen LLM platform to craft and test your prompts.
- > **Commit to one platform.** Switching AI platforms mid-competition is a disqualification, pick your tool and stick with it.
- > **No pre-written prompt libraries.** Every prompt must be written live; bringing canned prompt sets is not allowed.

// SCORING

05 SCORING

TRANSPARENT · WEIGHTED · ENFORCED

Scoring is transparent, weighted, and strictly enforced. A judge panel evaluates your prompts alongside live automated scoring, rewarding strong, accurate output produced with skill and efficiency. The full weighted breakdown is shared at the event before the rounds begin.

// CONDUCT_AND_EJECTION

06 CONDUCT & DISQUALIFICATION

THE CODE EVERY COMPETITOR MUST HONOR

- > **Stay solo.** No sharing strategies with other competitors during active competition.
- > **Your prompts are logged.** Every prompt is recorded, and plagiarism detection runs after the event.
- > **Organizer rulings are final.**

INSTANT DISQUALIFICATION

- > Switching AI platforms mid-competition
- > Sharing strategies with other competitors during the event
- > Using pre-written prompt libraries
- > Plagiarism, flagged through the logged-prompt review

ONLY ONE MASTERS THE MACHINE.
ENTER THE GAUNTLET.